

Weekly Self-Study Tasks to Complete

Phase 1 — Week 5: Flexbox, Bootstrap, and Responsive Design for Leaders

This document covers all of Week 5 in the 4-hour Leaders model: 2 hours of instructor-led session, 1 hour of self-study video, and 1 hour of hands-on lab. The Core Resources table below fits inside the 1-hour self-study media budget. The Practice Activities section points to the Evergreen Insurance Quote Page lab, where you will extend last week's page with a Flexbox benefits row and a media query that stacks it on phones. Additional Content at the end is optional and sits outside the 4-hour budget.

Core Resources (~55 min)

Watch the specific clips called out below — not the entire course. Every link and duration in this table has been verified against the source platform. Keep Chrome DevTools open as you watch: both videos reference the Flexbox overlay and media-query tools you saw in the instructor session.

Topic	Material Description	Est. Time	Link / Reference
Flexbox Overview	Hands-on Responsive Web Design 3: Columns, Flexbox, and Grids (Paul Cheney, Pluralsight, updated Dec 2, 2024) — watch the Introduction module (~3 min) and the Flexbox module (16 min). Leaders-appropriate walk through of what Flexbox is, what it solves, and how the axes work. You are welcome to skip the hands-on coding sections; the narration and on-screen demos carry the concepts.	~22 min	pluralsight.com — Hands-on Responsive Web Design 3

Topic	Material Description	Est. Time	Link / Reference
Flexbox + Responsive	CSS Essential Training (Christina Truong, LinkedIn Learning, released Aug 9, 2023) — watch two short slices. From Chapter 5 (Layouts: Flexbox and Grid): “Intro to Grid and Flexbox” (0:59), “Intro to Flexbox” (2:25), “Flexbox: Orientation and ordering” (3:01), “Sizing with flex properties” (2:29), “Aligning flex items” (3:20), “Intro to CSS Grid” (2:23). From Chapter 7 (Layouts: Fluid and Responsive): “Intro to responsive design” (1:29), “Intro to media queries” (4:32), “Breakpoints and media queries” (3:32), “The viewport meta tag” (1:53), “Testing responsive layouts” (3:01). Reinforces the instructor session and prepares you for the lab.	~33 min	linkedin.com/learning — CSS Essential Training (Ch. 5 + 7)

Practice Activities (1 hour)

Complete this week's hands-on lab: “Evergreen Insurance Quote Page — Responsive Layout.” The starter extends last week's page with a new three-card “Why Evergreen” benefits row that currently stacks vertically. You will turn it into a Flexbox row on desktop and add one media query that stacks it again on phones, using Chrome DevTools' visual pickers for justify-content and the Flexbox overlay. The whole exercise takes about one hour.

In the lab you will:

- Open the Labfiles/evergreen-quote-responsive-layout folder in VS Code and launch with Live Server.

- Observe that the three new benefit cards stack vertically on both desktop and mobile – the “before” state.
- Use Chrome DevTools Device Mode to toggle between desktop and phone widths and see how the layout breaks.
- Add `display: flex` to the `.benefit-list` container interactively in the Styles pane and watch the cards snap into a row.
- Click through `justify-content` values (`flex-start`, `center`, `space-between`, `space-around`, `space-evenly`) using the DevTools visual picker.
- Add `gap: 24px` for clean spacing and `flex: 1` on each `.benefit` so the cards share the row equally.
- Copy the winning values into `styles.css` so they persist after refresh.
- Add a `@media (max-width: 640px)` block that sets `flex-direction: column` on narrow screens; verify in DevTools that the cards stack cleanly on iPhone widths.
- Review the full change with `git diff styles.css`, then commit with “Make benefits row responsive with Flexbox and a media query”.

The lab instructions (with “Why this matters” callouts throughout) are in the lab environment. Budget one hour and work at your own pace.

Additional Content (Optional)

The following resources are optional and recommended for students who want to go deeper beyond the core curriculum. They are outside the 4-hour weekly budget. Bootstrap components (navbar, cards, buttons) and advanced Flexbox properties (flex-grow, flex-shrink, flex-basis) are not required for the Leaders track; skim only if curious.

Topic	Material Description	Link / Reference
Flexbox / Grid	Hands-on Responsive Web Design 3: Columns, Flexbox, and Grids — Paul Cheney (Pluralsight, Dec 2024). Full 2-hour course includes twelve-column grid project, CSS shapes, and Grid in addition to the Flexbox slice used in Core (Video Course)	pluralsight.com – full course

Topic	Material Description	Link / Reference
CSS Layouts (Depth)	CSS Layouts: From Float to Flexbox and Grid — Christina Truong (LinkedIn Learning, 2019). Older reference (~1h 42m) but the Flexbox and Grid chapters remain the clearest dedicated walk-through on the platform (Video Course)	linkedin.com/learning — CSS Layouts
Flexbox Reference	A Complete Guide to Flexbox — CSS-Tricks. The single most bookmarked Flexbox cheat sheet on the internet. Keep it open when you are reading a PR that touches layout (Reference)	css-tricks.com — Flexbox Guide
Flexbox Practice	Flexbox Froggy — a free browser game that teaches Flexbox through 24 levels of moving frogs onto lily pads. Optional but the fastest way to internalize justify-content and align-items (Interactive)	flexboxfroggy.com
Responsive Design	Responsive design — MDN Web Docs (updated 2025). Media queries, viewport meta, fluid layouts, and responsive images. Same MDN page linked in Week 4; deeper coverage now applies (Tutorial)	developer.mozilla.org — Responsive design
Flexbox (MDN)	Flexbox — MDN Web Docs (updated 2025). Authoritative reference covering the flex container, items, alignment, flex-grow / flex-shrink / flex-basis, and real-world examples (Reference)	developer.mozilla.org — Flexbox
Bootstrap	Bootstrap 5 Documentation — getbootstrap.com (Bootstrap 5.3, 2024+). Official reference for the grid, components, and utility classes. Worth skimming the Grid section so you can decode what `col-md-8` means the next time you see it in a PR (Reference)	getbootstrap.com — Grid documentation

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Browser Support	Can I Use — up-to-the-day browser-support matrix for every CSS feature, including Flexbox gap and container queries. Useful when you hear an engineer ask “is it safe to ship?” (Tool)	caniuse.com